

► Statue power

The 11th-century Byzantine scholar John Skylitzes was perturbed by the smashing of statues in earlier centuries and described John the Grammarian, who led the destruction, as an evil sorcerer. Here, Skylitzes depicts John indulging in *stoicheiosis*—statue magic.

τῆς βασίλειος κατέσχευεν ἡμῶν. σύγκλονεν μὲν πρῶτον τὸ τοῦ ἡρώου· εἰς τὴν ῥομφαίαν αὐτοῦ
ἀρχὴν καθήκει κῶν γὰρ τὸν πόλεον ;:· προγνώσει τὴν ἀσάλευτον μαρτυρίαν καὶ τὴν
τεῖαν αὐτῶν ἀπαγγέλλοντα· κατεπράχθη δὲ ποτε τὴν ῥομφαίαν· ἐπὶ τὸν αὐτὸν καὶ κλη
ρὸν· ὡς γὰρ ἐπὶ τὴν σφραγὶς ἡμῶν· καὶ ὡς ἐκ τῶν αὐτῶν τούτων τοῦ θεοφίλου ἀνὴρ ἡμῶν·
ἀποτέονται τὴν ἀλυσίαν ὅς ἡμῶν παρεκάμει· καὶ τὰς σὺν πληρωθῆναι εἰς γέγονον τὴν αὐτοῦ
συμβουλὴν περὶ τῆς ἀρχῆς· ἡ δὲ συμβουλὴ ἡν τοιαύτη· ἐμὲ τοῖς ἐπὶ τὸν αὐτὸν ἵππικόν
ἵσταντο· χαλκοῖς ἀμφοῖς· καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς ἵσταντο ἐλέγχο· τὴν ἀμφοῖς μερὸς κεφαλῆς
καὶ· προσηύδα τὸν ἡμῶν ἵσταντο σφύρας χαλκοῦ τῶν αὐτῶν κεφαλῶν· ἀν
δράστε τὰς αὐτῶν ἀρχαῖς ἵσταντο κατὰ χεῖρας γυναικῶν· κατὰ τὴν δὲ τεταμένην ῥομφαίαν
ἐπὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς γένεσθαι πρὸς τὸν ἐπὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς ἀνδρῶν· καὶ ἡνὶ κατόντοισι κελύεσθαι·
παίειν ἡνὶ σφύρας τὰς ἀμφοῖς τὰς κεφαλὰς· μετὰ τὴν κατεμειχθεῖν εἰς τὴν αὐτῶν
ῥομφαίαν καὶ τὴν αὐτῶν καὶ τὴν αὐτῶν καὶ τὴν αὐτῶν καὶ τὴν αὐτῶν καὶ τὴν αὐτῶν καὶ τὴν αὐτῶν
σετάξει· καὶ γέγονεν ὅς ἐκ τῶν ἀνδρῶν ἀμφοῖς ἵσταντο πόρρων ἡκτῶν· ἡν δὲ ἵ
σταντο μετὰ λαὸν τοῦ σφύρας· ἵνα μὴ κατὰ χεῖρας γένηται· τὸ ἵσταντο χεῖρας τοῦ σφύρας
γινώσκουσιν· καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς ἀμφοῖς ἵσταντο τὸν αὐτῶν τὸν ἀνδρῶν ἀμφοῖς ἀμφοῖς ἀμφοῖς
παίειν τὸν ἀνδρῶν καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς καὶ τὴν ἀμφοῖς

ἡνὶ κατόντοισι κελύεσθαι

People climb ladders
to destroy the statue

John the
Grammarian
conjures powers
from the statue

